Urban Redevelopment and Area-Based Community Development

- Case study: Kajicho 2-chome, Chiyoda City

再開発とエリアまちづくり

・千代田区 鍛冶町二丁目の事例

Original slide 1 of 45



Original slide 2 of 45

About the Presenter

- Megumi Migita (Urbanist Association / SharedVision)
- Background
- Studied architectural design and urban planning at Kogakuin University.
- Completed an urban planning and design studio at Meiji University’s International Professional Program, working with Japanese and international students.
- Practiced placemaking at Odawara Laboratory.
- Completed a four-month internship at atelierjones in Seattle.
- Joined Matsuda Hirata Design in 2016, promoting mainly urban redevelopment projects.
- Worked on redevelopment in Kanda and Kameido from 2018 through 2026.
- Joined City Lab Tokyo (Urbanist Association) and became a board member in 2021; also launched SharedVision to work on area management and related initiatives.
- Selected activities: Lead coordinator, Kajini Walkable Project (pilot); planning and management of watage, a place for learning and practice in Kanda; secretariat for the Hane-kame Community Development Project and Kameido Area Platform.
- Other affiliations: Japan Association of City Planning; Area Management Lab; Konandai Mejiro Housing Estate Regeneration Committee.

History of Community Development Activities in Kajicho 2-chome

- Timeline and background of local community development activities.



Original slide 3 of 45

Developing Community Development Proposals and a Basic Vision

- Preparation of proposals and a basic community development vision.

まちづくり案／まちづくり基本構想の作成



4

Original slide 4 of 45

Developing Community Development Guidelines

- Creating guidelines to guide local initiatives and future improvements.

まちづくりガイドラインの作成



Original slide 5 of 45

A Shared Framework for Local Action

- All actions in Kajicho 2-chome are being advanced around these community development guidelines.



Original slide 6 of 45

Action 1: Walkable Community Development

- A dim pedestrian passage beneath the elevated railway has become brighter, more welcoming, and more enjoyable.



Original slide 7 of 45

Key Points of the Community Development Guidelines

- Items 1, 2, and 4 of the physical improvement policy directly relate to walkability.
- Other themes—including greenery, community, townscape, and the environment—are also connected to walkable community development.



Original slide 8 of 45

A Space for People to Stay, Not Just Pass Through

- First held in 2022.
- Mölkky; simple place-making with camping equipment; planters made together; long tables for working on laptops, eating, and drinking; turf mats to brighten the space; air sofas for relaxing; clear signage.
- Local shops provided takeout, and visitors came from Nakameguro and even Hiroshima.
- A space that people normally passed through became a lively place full of activities.



Original slide 9 of 45

The Project Continued in 2025

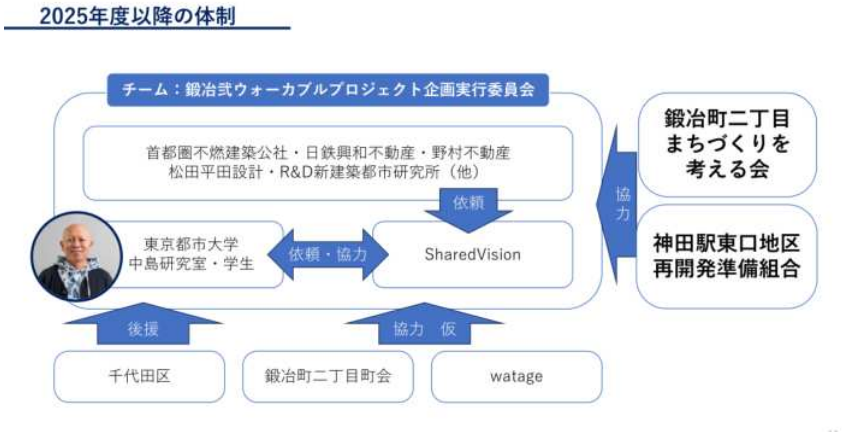
- The walkability experiment was carried out again in 2025.
- Before / After



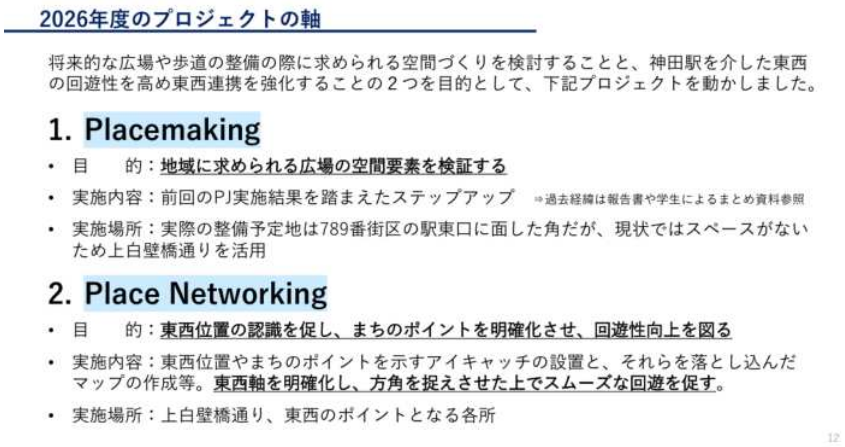
Original slide 10 of 45

Project Structure from FY2025

- Kajini Walkable Project Planning and Implementation Committee: Public Corporation for Urban Development, Nippon Steel Kowa Real Estate, Nomura Real Estate, Matsuda Hirata Design, R&D Institute of New Architecture and Urbanism, and others.
- Partners include Tokyo City University and its Nakajima Laboratory and students; SharedVision; Kajicho 2-chome Town Association; watage; Chiyoda City; the Kajicho 2-chome Community Development Group; and the Kanda Station East Exit District Redevelopment Preparatory Association.



Original slide 11 of 45



Original slide 12 of 45

Focus of the FY2026 Projects

- Two objectives: explore the kind of spaces needed when future plazas and sidewalks are developed, and strengthen east–west connections and pedestrian circulation across Kanda Station.
- 1. Placemaking — Test the spatial elements needed for a local plaza. Building on the results of previous projects. The future site is a corner of Block 789 facing the station’s east exit, but there is currently no available space, so Kamishirakabe Bridge Street will be used.
- 2. Place Networking — Make east–west locations and key places easier to recognize, improve legibility, and encourage people to explore the area. Install visual markers and create maps; clarify the east–west axis and directions. Locations: Kamishirakabe Bridge Street and key points to the east and west.

Kajini Walkable Project: October 8–9, 2026

- The fourth Kajini Walkable Project was held to translate the Kajicho 2-chome guidelines into concrete actions and support development of a basic community vision around Kanda Station.
- Experiments included varied seating and stay spaces for a future station-front plaza, and signs to encourage east–west circulation, including pavement markings, signs showing the direction of the current location, and a stamp rally.



Original slide 13 of 45

Programs to Encourage East–West Walking and Exploration

- A range of programs designed to help people navigate and explore both sides of Kanda Station.



東西回遊性を促す各種プログラム

Original slide 14 of 45

Action 2: Experimenting with the Use of Vacant Buildings

- Experiments brought activity to vacant buildings and turned them into places for local people to gather.



Original slide 15 of 45

English Notes



Original slide 16 of 45

Action 3: Creating a Community Hub by Reusing Vacant Buildings

- Reusing existing buildings to create a local place for connection and activity.



Original slide 17 of 45

Key Points of the Community Development Guidelines

- Items 4, 5, and 7 of the physical improvement policy relate to creating community hubs.



Original slide 18 of 45

watage: A Place to Learn and Practice While Nurturing the Community

- watage took over the site of Tampopo, a much-loved local café and gathering place in Kajicho 2-chome. It was created to nurture learning and practice that can become seeds for future community development.
- Together with local residents and young people in their teens and twenties, participants develop the knowledge and skills to make better use of their town. Through these activities, local resources are made visible and reinterpreted, while people and resources are cultivated as assets for the future.
- Cultivation Talk — Talks and workshops with practitioners and creatives involved in community development, sharing knowledge and inspiration for future ways of living and building cross-disciplinary connections.
- Youth Studio — A one-month to six-month learning and practice program for young people. Using Kanda as a field of exploration, participants propose ways to design a richer everyday life, uncover creative talent, and identify and build on local resources.



Original slide 19 of 45

English Notes



Original slide 20 of 45

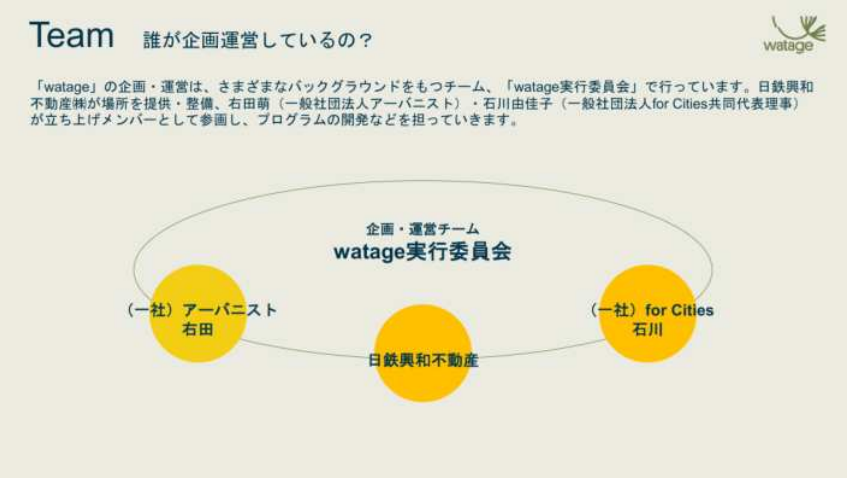
English Notes



Original slide 21 of 45

Who Plans and Runs watage?

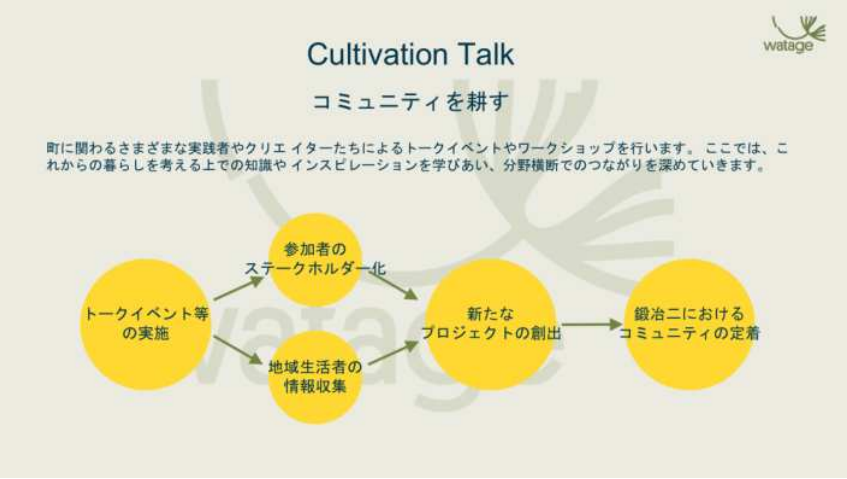
- watage is planned and managed by the watage Executive Committee, a team with diverse backgrounds.
- Nippon Steel Kowa Real Estate provides and prepares the space. Megumi Migita (Urbanist Association) and Yukako Ishikawa (Co-Executive Director of for Cities) joined as founding members and lead program development.



Original slide 22 of 45

Cultivation Talk: Cultivating Community

- Talks and workshops with practitioners and creatives from across the community help participants learn knowledge and gain inspiration for thinking about future ways of living, while deepening connections across fields.
- Activities can lead to participants becoming stakeholders, new projects emerging, and a lasting community in Kajini; they also help gather information from local residents.



Original slide 23 of 45

English Notes



Original slide 24 of 45

Coming Soon…

- The next theme: Reusing closed schools in central Tokyo.



Original slide 25 of 45

Recreating a Beloved Dish from Tampopo

- Taking on the challenge of recreating the Napolitan spaghetti once loved at Tampopo, the café that preceded watage.



Original slide 26 of 45

A New Year’s Live Performance

- A live performance was held alongside the New Year gathering with Mr. Mishina, a member of the local town association who enjoys chanson.



Original slide 27 of 45

Growing Indigo with the Kanda Indigo Association

- In partnership with the Kanda Indigo Association, indigo was grown in watage’s flower beds, progressing to hands-on dyeing techniques using pounding, fresh leaves, and dried leaves.



Original slide 28 of 45



Original slide 29 of 45

watage youth studio

- Who will shape our town 10 or 20 years from now?
- An urban design studio for young people.

English Notes



Original slide 30 of 45

Studio #01: Placemaking After Dark

- A Place You Want to Be at Night
- During a summer school held August 18–30, participants aged 25 and under explored how to make richer use of the hours after sunset. Through dialogue, field research, and expert lectures, they examined the potential of nighttime spaces. They presented their findings and proposals for a “night plaza” using models and mock-ups.



Original slide 31 of 45

Made with Youth

- Creating things in the town together with young people.



Original slide 32 of 45

Made with Youth #01: Torima Coffee

- Free coffee that connects the neighborhood.
- Torima Coffee is a collaborative coffee-break experiment held every other week at watage. Participants work together on coffee blends and the setup of the space, aiming to grow watage into a “living room for everyone.” It seeks to create new connections between people and the town through everyday conversations and small moments of engagement.
- Youth: Yuka Koizumi. Born in 2001. After graduating from Meiji University’s Department of Architecture, School of Science and Technology, she joined the nonprofit CHAr. As a student, she took part in community development through building renovation in Hakone, Higashimatsuyama, and Nihonbashi. After joining the first watage youth studio in summer 2023, she launched the Torima Coffee free-coffee project at watage.



Original slide 33 of 45

Torima Coffee Enters Its Second Generation

- As the original Torima Coffee team moved on, students from Tokyo City University who had participated in the Kajini Walkable Project took an interest and continued the initiative.
- They still serve coffee from the window about twice a month, on Wednesdays from 11:30 a.m. to 1:30 p.m.



Original slide 34 of 45

English Notes



Original slide 35 of 45

Everyday Operations

- The space continues to open about three days a week.
- Use by the town association’s welfare committee has increased, especially since around November, and regular visitors now come to have tea.
- Meetings related to the Kanda Festival and urban redevelopment are also becoming more frequent.



Original slide 36 of 45

The Kajicho 2-chome Community Development Guidelines: A Compass for watage

- The guidelines provide the direction for watage’s activities.



Original slide 37 of 45

Expanding Programs and Local Initiative at watage

- Activities build on the seven items in the Kajicho 2-chome Community Development Guidelines, while incorporating new perspectives made possible by watage’s unique network.
- As initiatives extend outward, local ownership grows and opportunities to collaborate with external partners increase.
- The diagram maps related initiatives, including walkability, youth programs, public life, culture, waste reduction, mobility, vacant-school reuse, indigo dyeing, Torima Coffee, and other experiments. Red circles indicate programs planned from FY2026 onward.



Original slide 38 of 45

Action 4: Closed-School Reuse Project

- Experiments explored ways to reuse a closed school, focusing on disaster preparedness and culture.



Original slide 39 of 45

Key Points of the Community Development Guidelines

- Items 4, 5, and 7 of the physical improvement policy relate to creating community hubs.



Original slide 40 of 45

Designing Programs Based on Local Needs and Future Directions

- Programs are planned in response to local needs and long-term goals.



Original slide 41 of 45



プログラムと地域連携

プログラム名	プログラム詳細	協力者	スタッフ担当	備考
①防災：防災キャンプ	• 備蓄の防災食をみんなで食べてみる • 火を起こしてお湯を沸かしたり、ソーセージ等を焼いて食べる	デベロッパー	エリマネラボ	防災食入手済み 焚火セットなど要準備 区と消防署へ連絡
②防災：防災講座	• 防災に関する講座	消防団のＡさん	松平	消防団と要調整
③防災：防災情報展示	• ハザードマップ等の展示	元町会長	エリマネラボ	千代田区へ問合せ：松平
④防災：大人の特別講座	• 廃校のエコ改修をテーマとしたトークイベント	東大：村山先生 町会のＢさん	松平	村山先生と調整
⑤文化：お囃子体験	• お囃子の体験	お囃子部のＣさん	エリマネラボ	鼓鍛冶と要調整
⑥文化：歴史・文化展示	• 火消しや祭文化の展示 • 歴史的偉人の展示 • 神田祭の映像 • 8ミリフィルムの映像	元町会長 元副町会長 町会のＢさん お囃子部のＣさん 千代田区観光協会	松平	備品選び出し調整 観光協会と要調整 映像を要事前入手
⑦文化：こどもの遊び場	• モルック • 芝生や遊びコーナー	デベロッパー 関係企業	エリマネラボ	広友物産と調整
⑧文化：キッチンカー	• 滞在空間に飲食提供を併設させる実験	関係企業	エリマネラボ	キッチンカーの方と調整

42

Original slide 42 of 45

Programs and Local Partnerships

- 1. Disaster preparedness camp — Try emergency food from stored supplies; make a fire, boil water, and cook sausages. Partners: developer; staff: Area Management Lab. Emergency food has been secured; prepare firepit equipment and contact the ward and fire department.
- 2. Disaster preparedness lecture — A lecture on disaster readiness. Coordinate with a member of the volunteer fire corps.
- 3. Disaster information exhibition — Display hazard maps and related information. Contact Chiyoda City.
- 4. Special lecture for adults — A talk on eco-renovation of closed schools. Coordinate with Professor Murayama at the University of Tokyo and local representatives.
- 5. Traditional festival music experience — Hands-on experience with festival music. Coordinate with the local festival music group.
- 6. History and culture exhibition — Displays on firefighting and festival culture, historical figures, Kanda Festival footage, and 8 mm film. Coordinate with the tourism association and arrange footage in advance.
- 7. Children’s play area — Mölkky, turf, and play corners. Coordinate with participating companies and suppliers.
- 8. Food truck — Experiment with providing food and drink alongside the stay space. Coordinate with food truck operators.

Action 5: Public Space Improvements and Urban Redevelopment

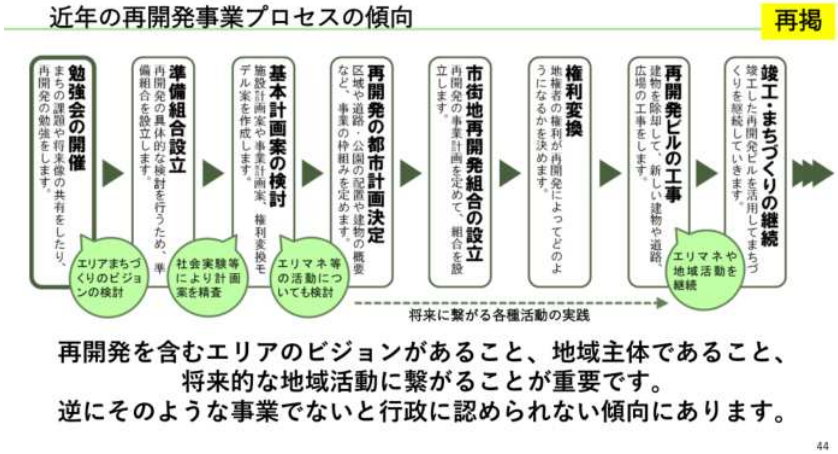
- Taking on challenges that cannot be solved through programming alone and require physical improvements.



Original slide 43 of 45

Recent Trends in Urban Redevelopment Processes

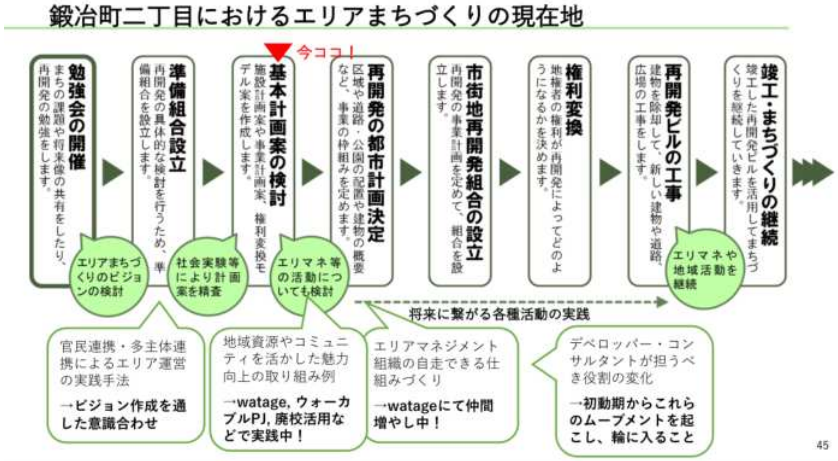
- Implementing a range of activities that can lead to future initiatives.
- It is important to have a vision for the area—including redevelopment—to be community-led, and to connect projects to future local activities.
- Projects that do not meet these conditions increasingly tend not to be accepted by public authorities.



Original slide 44 of 45

Where Area-Based Community Development in Kajicho 2-chome Stands Today

- Current position: putting into practice a range of activities that can lead to the future.
- Key themes: area management through public–private and multi-stakeholder collaboration; improving local appeal by using community assets and networks; creating a self-sustaining area management organization; and evolving the role of developers and consultants.
- Examples: aligning stakeholders through a shared vision; ongoing practice through watage, the Walkable Project, and closed-school reuse; building a wider network at watage; and initiating these movements from the early stages of a project.



Original slide 45 of 45